

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL · EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT · JUNE 2026

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT & ENGAGEMENT PROPOSAL

Swiss Payments Platform · From Architectural Promise to Commercial Reality

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STRATEGIC CONTEXT

The Platform, The Gap, and The Moment

Swiss Payments occupies a strategically significant position within the MSS portfolio — a multi-tenant fintech infrastructure platform built at the intersection of regulated fiat payments, digital asset custody, and B2B financial services. The architecture is substantive: multi-tenant from the database layer up, Fireblocks institutional custody, double-entry ledger, real-time compliance monitoring. These are not trivial constructions. The engineering team has done serious work.

The technical review of 22 June 2026 identified, however, a material and measurable gap between the platform's current operational state and the minimum viable threshold for commercial operations, regulatory defensibility, and institutional client acquisition. This gap — if left unaddressed — represents a compounding risk to the MSS investment thesis: not because the platform cannot succeed, but because the path from here to there requires a specific quality of leadership that is not currently present within the Swiss Payments organisation.

"The platform is not broken. It is unfinished. In regulated finance, the distance between unfinished and live is not measured in features — it is measured in liability, regulatory exposure, and the confidence of the clients you are trying to win."

THE WEIGHT OF WHAT IS BEING BUILT

Knowledge Without Experience Is the Most Expensive Mistake in Fintech

The BaaS and multi-tenant fintech infrastructure sector carries a graveyard of platforms that had good technology and insufficient operating experience at the leadership level. These are not cautionary tales about bad ideas — they are cautionary tales about the specific and dangerous gap between knowing how to build and knowing how to operate.

PLATFORM	OUTCOME	ROOT CAUSE OF FAILURE	DIRECT PARALLEL TO SWISS PAYMENTS
Synapse	Collapsed 2024 \$100M+ funds frozen	Engineering-led. Compliance treated as a feature, not the product. No experienced compliance operator in leadership.	Swiss Payments compliance module is a case-management UI. No SAR workflow. No automated TM rules. Same failure mode — pre-collapse.
Railsr (Railsbank)	Administration CVA 2022	Strong architecture, no commercial discipline. Scaled headcount and infrastructure without matching revenue or operational rigour.	35 FTE, 2 product managers, no CPO, no live revenue. Engineering is ahead of every other function.
Wirecard	Fraud / Collapse €1.9B missing	Regulatory opacity exploited. "Many licences" and vague compliance positioning used to obscure operational reality.	"Many licences" was the response to a direct question about FINMA and EMI status. Licensing opacity is a red flag at any stage.
Pocket / Anna Money	Near-failure Strategic pivot	Launched prematurely. Compliance gaps surfaced under FCA scrutiny post-launch. Expensive remediation consumed fundraising runway.	Mid-July go-live target cannot be met as currently structured. Launching prematurely into a regulated environment is recoverable — but expensive.

The common thread is not insufficient capital, nor insufficient engineering — it is the absence of an experienced operator who has navigated the specific intersection of product, compliance, commercial, and regulatory demands that a platform of this ambition requires. Thomas K Matecki has sat in that seat — at Zilch, at scale, under regulatory scrutiny — and delivered. That is the credential being offered here, and it is the only credential that matters at this stage.

PLATFORM FINDINGS — SEVERITY MATRIX

Eight Material Deficiencies Identified — Investment Committee Briefing

SEVERITY	AREA	FINDING	COMMERCIAL IMPLICATION
CRITICAL	Infrastructure	Demo served from localhost:3000 — no staging/production environment parity	Any published go-live date is commercially fictitious until resolved
CRITICAL	Payment Rails	Currencycloud integration: 100% error rate / DOWN at time of review with no active incident response	Core payment rail dependency inoperative — mission-critical remediation required immediately
CRITICAL	Card Programme	No card issuer or programme manager selected. Procurement-to-live: 90–180 days minimum	Mid-July card go-live is not achievable under any current organisational trajectory
CRITICAL	Compliance Engine	Compliance module is a case-management UI. No SAR workflow, no automated TM rules, no risk scoring	Regulatory liability in any jurisdiction where AML obligations attach to the platform operator
SIGNIFICANT	Onboarding	KYB entirely manual — no automated workflow, no in-platform operator tooling	Unscalable at any meaningful tenant volume; creates compounding compliance exposure
SIGNIFICANT	Trading Integrations	B2C2 error rate at 5.06% — fails standard institutional ODD requirements	Would be rejected by any regulated enterprise client in operational due diligence
SIGNIFICANT	Organisation	35 FTE, 2 product managers, no CPO — engineering-led without product governance or commercial function	Platform optimised for build velocity, not for adoption, compliance, or revenue accountability
SIGNIFICANT	Regulatory	"Many licences" was the direct response to questions about FINMA, EMI, and SRO scope	Untenable for tenant due diligence, investor data rooms, or any substantive regulatory conversation

PHASE ZERO — ON-SITE DUE DILIGENCE

14 Days in Dubai — The Non-Negotiable Starting Point

No engagement of this magnitude — financial, operational, and reputational — is entered into without direct, in-person verification. Before any mandate commences, Thomas K Matecki will conduct a structured 14-day on-site due diligence programme in Dubai, working directly and intensively with the Swiss Payments leadership team, the engineering organisation, the compliance function, and the banking partners.

This is not a site visit. It is a working deployment. The output is a verified, independently-produced assessment of every dimension of the platform — technical, regulatory, commercial, and organisational — that forms the definitive basis for the mandate scope, the remediation priorities, and the 90-day execution plan.

WEEK 1 Days 1–7	FOCUS AREAS	WEEK 2 Days 8–14	FOCUS AREAS
Technical Architecture Deep Dive	Full codebase review · Database architecture · Integration audit (Fireblocks, Currencycloud, B2C2, Kraken) · CI/CD pipeline · Security posture · Infrastructure topology	Commercial & Regulatory Assessment	Licensing documentation review · Banking partner agreement audit · Tenant pipeline assessment · Go-to-market strategy evaluation · Competitive positioning analysis
Compliance & Risk Framework	AML/CFT framework assessment · KYC/KYB workflow review · SAR procedures · Transaction monitoring rules · PEP screening · Sanctions compliance posture	Organisational & Delivery Assessment	Leadership interviews · Team capability mapping · Product roadmap review · Sprint process assessment · Delivery velocity analysis · Org structure recommendations
Banking & Partner Review	Sumsup integration · Fireblocks custody configuration · Kraken trading setup · Wise, Bvnk, Modulr review · Banking rail health check · Error rate triage	Board-Ready Output Document	Verified findings report · Prioritised remediation plan · Revised go-live date with full rationale · 90-day mandate execution plan · Investment Committee briefing pack

LOGISTICS

The on-site due diligence programme is conducted at full cost to Swiss Payments / MSS Investments Holding, including: business-class return flights London–Dubai · five-star hotel accommodation (14 nights) · ground transportation and driver on-site · executive working facilities. This cost is entirely separate from and in addition to the mandate fee structure. It reflects the seriousness of the engagement and ensures Thomas K Matecki is in the optimal position to deliver a thorough, independent, and actionable assessment.

PROPOSED MANDATE STRUCTURES

Three Frameworks — Investment Committee Selection

Three mandate structures are presented in ascending order of operational scope, financial commitment, and strategic integration. Each is commercially viable on a standalone basis and structured with incentives aligned to platform outcomes. Professional fees reflect a senior operator with a demonstrated track record of delivering regulated fintech at unicorn scale — not a consulting generalist. The Investment Committee is invited to select the framework appropriate to MSS's intended pace and depth of portfolio intervention.

	FRAMEWORK A Advisory & Technical Oversight	FRAMEWORK B ♦ Transformation Partner [RECOMMENDED]	FRAMEWORK C Full Executive Mandate
Engagement	Fractional CPO/Strategy Officer 2 days/week · Nexa9 targeted delivery	Head of Product & Transformation or MD Product · Full Nexa9 team 4–6 senior engineers · 6-month term	Interim CEO or COO Full mandate, board-level reporting Nexa9 as primary tech partner 12-month minimum
Executive Engagement Fee	£38,000 / month	£48,000 / month	£65,000 / month
Nexa9 Services	From £35,000/month (scoped per module)	£65,000–£90,000/month (team of 4–6)	£110,000+/month (primary tech partner)
Equity Participation	1.5% — Swiss Payments or MSS holding entity	3–4% + milestone success fee at £1M ARR	5–7% + exit kicker at £5M ARR or M&A; event
On-Site DD	14 days Dubai (fully expensed, all mandates)	14 days Dubai (fully expensed, all mandates)	14 days Dubai (fully expensed, all mandates)
Term	3 months initial (rolling monthly)	6 months minimum (30-day performance review)	12 months minimum (quarterly board review)
Key Deliverables	• Platform & compliance audit • Card programme selection • Licensing clarity roadmap • NICO as pilot anchor tenant • MSS/NICO seed conversation	• Compliance engine rebuilt • Card issuer contracted (30 days) • KYB automation live • NICO as Tenant #1 — live MRR • MSS investor in NICO seed • First 10 tenants targeted	• Full platform productisation • Team restructure under Nexa9 • Investor-grade data room • NICO co-marketing rights • MSS as NICO seed lead • M&A; positioning programme

All executive engagement fees are structured under formal Executive Engagement Agreements governed by English law, LCIA arbitration. Nexa9 services are contracted under a separate Technology Services Agreement. Equity participation is subject to legal structuring, shareholder consent, and mutual due diligence. A 30-day probationary performance review applies to all frameworks.

DUAL STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP ARCHITECTURE

NICO Capital × Swiss Payments × MSS Investments — A Compounding Value Structure

The most significant aspect of this proposal is not the executive mandate — it is the dual-track strategic partnership that creates compounding portfolio value for MSS Investments across two assets simultaneously. This is not incidental to the engagement. It is the architecture that makes the whole more valuable than the sum of its parts.

TRACK A · NICO CAPITAL as Anchor Tenant	THE FLYWHEEL Aligned Incentives, Compounding Value	TRACK B · MSS INVESTMENTS as NICO Capital Seed Investor
NICO Capital (nico.money) executes a white-label tenant agreement with Swiss Payments from day one of the engagement. NICO becomes the platform's first named, commercially active anchor tenant — generating contracted MRR immediately. Thomas K Matecki controls delivery on both sides, eliminating the typical gap between promise and performance.	MSS is a stronger investor in NICO when NICO is a live Swiss Payments tenant — infrastructure risk is de-risked. Swiss Payments is more credible to future tenants when a Zilch-pedigree neobank is already live on it. Both portfolio assets appreciate precisely because of the other. Thomas K Matecki sits at the strategic centre of both.	MSS Investments participates in NICO Capital's £10M seed raise. A £500K–£1M strategic participation provides direct exposure to the Caribbean and Dominican Republic market: 11M+ population, \$10B+ remittance inflows per annum, zero dominant neobank — led by a founder who has previously delivered a \$2B+ fintech at institutional scale.

EXECUTION ROADMAP

Critical Path to Commercial Viability — First 90 Days
Post-Mandate

PHASE	FOCUS	KEY DELIVERABLES	RESPONSIBILITY
PHASE 0 14 Days	ON-SITE DUE DILIGENCE — DUBAI	Full technical, compliance, and organisational audit. Verified findings report. Revised go-live date. Board-ready assessment.	TKM on-site (fully expensed)
PHASE 1 Days 1–14	IMMEDIATE TRIAGE	Currencycloud resolved or substituted. B2C2 error rate addressed. Localhost replaced with staging/production environment. Licensing clarified with legal counsel. Incident response protocols established.	TKM + Nexa9
PHASE 2 Days 15–30	FOUNDATION	Card programme: issuer shortlisted, commercial conversations initiated. KYB automated workflow designed and scoped. Realistic go-live date agreed. NICO Capital LOI as Tenant #1 executed. MSS/NICO seed conversation opened.	TKM
PHASE 3 Days 31–60	BUILD	Transaction monitoring rules implemented. SAR workflow operational. Production environment fully deployed. KYB live in sandbox. Mobile app submitted to stores. Card issuer agreement in negotiation.	Nexa9 + Swiss Payments
PHASE 4 Days 61–90	COMMERCIAL ACTIVATION	NICO Capital live as Tenant #1 — contracted MRR on platform. Card issuer agreement executed. First 3 external tenants in active due diligence. Investor-grade data room complete. MSS/NICO seed term sheet in progress.	TKM

INVESTMENT COMMITTEE — RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

Five Actions for Immediate Authorisation

01	Authorise On-Site Due Diligence Confirm 14-day Dubai programme. Arrange business-class flights, five-star accommodation, and ground transportation for Thomas K Matecki. Issue confirmation within 5 business days. This is the non-negotiable starting point for any mandate.
02	Select and Authorise Mandate Framework Issue a Letter of Intent for the selected framework (B recommended) within 5 business days of this review. Provides the basis for the Executive Engagement Agreement to be drafted and executed.
03	Authorise Nexa9 Technology Services Agreement Direct Swiss Payments management to initiate the Nexa9 engagement in parallel — initial 6-month term, 30-day milestone review. Not contingent on the executive agreement; can be commenced immediately.
04	Initiate NICO Capital Due Diligence Direct the MSS investment team to commence due diligence on NICO Capital's £10M seed round. The £500K–£1M strategic participation is independently compelling and further de-risked by the Swiss Payments infrastructure partnership.

05

Grant Full Platform Access

Provide Thomas K Matecki with complete platform access, all licensing documentation, banking partner agreements, and technical architecture materials within 5 business days of mandate indication. Critical path for on-site audit.

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